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[00:06:24] The House will come to order. Members, please take your seats. Head page. The House is now in session. All persons not entitled to the privileges of the floor, please retire to the gallery.

[00:06:43] So mercy. The members will rise and be led in prayer by the Honorable Dolores L. McQueen, the delegate from Henrico, and remain standing for the pledge of allegiance to the flag of the United States of America, which will be led by the delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Let us pray.

[00:07:03] O gracious God and eternal Father, we come into this chamber this day with grateful hearts, with a deep awareness of the responsibilities placed upon our shoulders. We thank you for the blessing of another day of service, and we thank you for the trust of the people, and we thank you for the opportunity to labor on the behalf of this commonwealth that we love. God, as we are gathered here where laws are shaped and futures are of influence, we ask that you order our steps and guide our deliberation. When debates grow spirited, grant us grace. When challenges seem complex,

[00:07:43] grant us clarity. And when the road before us feel uncertain, grant us wisdom and steady resolve. Help us to remember that we sit here not by accident, but by assignment. An assignment to serve, an assignment to listen, an assignment to stand in the gap for those who are counting on us.

[00:08:02] Let our words be seasoned with respect. Let our decisions be anchored in fairness. And let our work be driven not by division, but by a shared commitment for the common good. Grant us courage to speak the truth, courage to seek justice, and courage to extend compassion.

[00:08:21] And let everything we do reflect our duty, not only to this moment, but to generations yet to come. In your precious name, we pray. Amen. Amen.

[00:08:39] The members will answer the roll call by indicating their presence on the electronic voting board.

[00:09:10] Clerk will close the roll. Mr. Speaker, a quorum is present.

[00:09:25] Pursuant to House Rule 3, I've examined and approved the journal of the House of Delegates for February 16, 2026. Motions and resolutions under Rule 39 pursuant to the provisions of Rule 40 are now in order. Does the clerk have any announcements or communications? No announcements or communications today. So, accordingly, in this first portion of the morning hour, pursuant to House Rule 40, the Speaker requests that you use your request to speak button for the agenda items listed for reference up on the voting board.

[00:09:51] Delegate from Henrico, Delegate Lovere-Bowling. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I ask today for an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. We have in the gallery Birth in Color, and I would ask they please stand if they're able. Birth in Color is an organization transforming maternal health outcomes across the Commonwealth.

[00:10:11] Founded in 2018, Birth in Color is a Virginia-based nonprofit advancing maternal health and infant health through culturally responsive care, doula services, childbirth education, lactation support, father engagement, and policy advocacy. It is the only black-led reproductive justice organization in Virginia focused specifically on black maternal health and operates the largest doula collective in the Commonwealth, training and mentoring providers while serving families across multiple regions.

[00:10:42] Each year, the organization supports hundreds of families and works with policymakers to improve postpartum care and reduce maternal mortality. Members, please join me in recognizing Birth in Color for its leadership and dedication to healthier families across Virginia. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. The delegate from Giles County, Delegate Ballard.

[00:11:10] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I'll rise for an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Members of the House, joining us in the gallery today are several realtor associations from Southwest and Central Virginia. I ask that they please stand. Members of the House, these realtors represent communities that are as diverse as they are resilient, urban centers, rural towns, historic main streets, and growing neighborhoods, and they work every day to support homeownership, economic development, and strong local communities across the Commonwealth. Beyond helping Virginians achieve the dream of homeownership, these members are deeply engaged civic leaders and trusted partners in shaping thoughtful housing policy.

[00:11:50] Their presence here today reflects a commitment not only to their profession, but to the future of Virginia. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, I ask that you join me in giving a warm house welcome to these realtors from the New River Valley, Southwest Virginia, Rockbridge Highlands, and the Roanoke Valley. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. The delegate from Prince William, Delegate Franklin.

Good morning, Mr. Speaker. I rise for the purpose of an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I would like to take a moment to recognize March

[00:12:29] of Dimes and the dedicated advocates who have been leading the fight to improve maternal and infant health outcomes in the Commonwealth. If March of Dimes can please stand. Through their leadership, partnership, and tireless advocacy, they have brought families, clinicians, and community leaders together to advance meaningful, evidence-based solutions to better support families in the Commonwealth.

[00:12:53] The national organization has existed for 87 years and provided important work throughout the Commonwealth. Please give them a warm welcome. Thank you. Welcome.

[00:13:10] Welcome to the Capitol. The Delegate from Rockbridge, Delegate McLaughlin. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. our rise for an announcement. But Doug has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. We are getting really close to the 18th annual Capitol Square Classic, the House versus the Senate. This is on February 23rd. Now, I know that we're all excited about the game, and it is excited, and it will be exciting, but I will tell you that I'm not excited as much about the basketball as I am excited about what we are advocating for. Unfortunately, Mr. Speaker, cancer is something that is really near

[00:13:43] and dear to me, unfortunately. But I'm not alone. There's a lot of people in this body that have experienced the loss of a loved one to an incurable cancer. This is 2026. This is our chance to come together and to do something about it. So for all of us that are going to enjoy the game, remember there are people that are out there fighting and it's not just a game. If you have contributed so far, Delegate McQuinn and I, we really thank you for that. If you have not, I will find you. So Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:14:20] Wow, sounds like a U.S. Marshal. The delegate from Prince William, Delegatorian. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise to the motion. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, today when the House adjourned, I would ask that we do so in honor and memory of the Reverend Jesse Jackson, and I would like to speak to that motion.

[00:14:43] The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, we remember Rosa Parks. Mr. Speaker, we remember the Reverend Dr. Martin Luther King Jr.

[00:14:59] Mr. Speaker, we remember Congressman John Lewis. And Mr. Speaker, on this day, this Tuesday morning, another great voice, another great icon of the civil rights movement and a leader in these United States, the voice of the Reverend Jesse Lewis Jackson, Sr. became silent today.

[00:15:24] He was born in Greenville, South Carolina. He attended the University of Illinois on a football scholarship before transferring to North Carolina A&T State University because the University of Illinois would not allow him to play the quarterback position.

[00:15:46] And, Mr. Speaker, just a light moment. While he was at North Carolina A&T, he became a brother of the Omega Psi Phi Fraternity Incorporated. In 1965, he went to work for the Reverend Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. in the Civil Rights Movement.

[00:16:04] While there, he was the founder of the Operation Push and also the Rainbow Coalition. And because he loved this nation so much, in 1984, he ran for the presidency of the United States of America.

[00:16:21] And he ran again in 1988. He was such a great leader, such a great preacher. And often, when he would end his speeches, he would say to his audience, hold on, hold out, keep hope alive.

[00:16:37] And Mr. Speaker, as we remember him today, let us encourage all of us to hold on, to hold out, and to keep hope alive. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Prince William, Delegate Torrin, moves that when the House adjourned today, it do so in the honor of Jesse Lewis Jackson, Sr.

[00:17:11] All those in favor of the motion shall please rise. The motion is agreed to. The delegate from Arlington, Delegate Hope. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a motion.

[00:17:27] The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I would move that House Bill 1432, that's on page 94, that's House Bill 1432 on page 94, be re-referred to the Courts of Justice Committee and carried over until 2027 under Rule 22.

[00:17:46] The delegate from Marley to Delegate Hope moves that HB 1432, found on page 94, be re-referred to the Committee on the Courts of Justice and carried over in accordance with Rule 22 until 2027. All those in favor, say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to the delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Bolivar.

[00:18:03] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for the purpose of an introduction. The delegate has the floor. I am pleased to recognize the tremendous impact AmeriCorps has in Virginia and to recognize the AmeriCorps members, alumni, and supporters joining us in the gallery today.

[00:18:20] Would you please stand? Today we are joined by AmeriCorps members, program staff, and commission staff. We are also joined by members of the Governor's Advisory Board on Service and Volunteerism and the Virginia Service Foundation. All of these groups work together to make an impact through AmeriCorps. I'd also like to recognize our colleagues in the House that served in AmeriCorps, Delegates Coulson, Lauffer, and Leader Herring. AmeriCorps is a powerful national service program that engages Americans across the country. Last year alone, more than 3,000 AmeriCorps members

[00:18:58] served on nearly 400 sites in Virginia alone. I am extremely proud to have AmeriCorps members serving in my district. AmeriCorps programs, along with other community service initiatives, including the Governor's Award on Volunteerism and Community Service, are supported by Serve Virginia, the Virginia Service Foundation, and the Governor's Advisory Board on Service and Volunteerism.

[00:19:24] I invite my colleagues to engage with AmeriCorps directly and schedule a site visit in your district. Please give a warm house welcome to those who are visiting the General Assembly today, spotlighting the remarkable volunteer efforts of AmeriCorps and the important role they are playing in strengthening communities across Virginia.

[00:19:44] Thank you. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. From Alexandria, Delegate McGuire. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for an introduction.

[00:20:01] Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I'm excited to welcome the John Lewis Leadership Program from Lewis High School in the 17th District here today, and I'd ask them to please rise. The John R. Lewis Leadership Program of the John R. Lewis High School in Fairfax County is a unique program in its fourth year that connects all its students to the legacy of Representative John Lewis.

[00:20:22] They're meaningful, hands-on learning about leadership, justice, service, and advocacy inside and outside the classroom. Through this program, Lewis High School students access unique opportunities designed just for them. The students are here today to talk to legislators about their service projects, and as Delegate Boliva mentioned, and to advocate for AmeriCorps.

[00:20:41] The students' projects include supporting students who are seeking to earn certifications in fields like AI by helping them enroll in courses that enable workforce preparedness upon graduation, using art to express the importance of civic participation, supporting immigrant rights, environmental protection, and promoting health care for all.

[00:20:58] Through these projects, our students have made a considerable impact upon their peers, families and broader community thereby transforming education into truly meaningful lifelong learning experiences and i want to thank them for their service at the 17th district and hope it will be the will of the body to wish them a welcome to the general assembly welcome welcome to the capital today the delegate from roanoke delegate rasul thank you mr speaker mr speaker i rise for motion like to speak to the motion dougat has the floor thank you mr speaker um so we have a a procedural

[00:21:36] issue with one bill, House Bill 786 by Delegate Austin that came to the floor, was engrossed, went back to committee, and we passed out the engrossed version and didn't go back to the committee passed version. So all we're doing is putting this in a proper procedural posture.

[00:21:54] In a moment, I'm going to make a motion to just reconsider it, and then later in the calendar, we're going to take final action on the bill. So, Mr. Speaker, I would move that having voted on the prevailing side by which we engrossed House Bill 786, that we move to reconsider that vote.

[00:22:11] All those in favor of the motion to reconsider the vote on HB 786, all those in favor say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. Ms. Speaker, members of the House, House Bill 786 will be taken up on the House bills on second reading regular calendar category, which will come at the very end of today's regular calendar once we hit a page 141, I believe.

[00:22:35] Pursuant to House Rule 30, the journal shall reflect that the following members are granted leave. On a way on pressing personal business, I'm going to leave from today's session, Delegates Clark, Knight, McAuliffe, and Phillips. Clerk will announce the next order. Second portion of the morning hours, the announcement of member requests to move legislation from uncontested calendar to the regular.

[00:22:55] There are three in that very first large category, House Bill's third, uncontested, page 8, Delegate Cousins, House Bill 845, out of the block. and on page 15, Delegate Maldonado's House Bill 1361 and Delegate Doherty's House Bill 1363.

[00:23:17] Those are out of the block over to the regular calendar. All three of those requests are by Delegate Wyatt. That's all I'm aware of. Clerk will announce the next item. I'm going to speak on the third portion of the morning hour. Legislature goodbye for the day. This being crossover, I'm not aware of any such requests. Clerk will call the calendar. Calendar for today, Tuesday, February 17, 2026.

[00:23:38] 260 plus bills, live bills to be dispensed with today, spread across pages 1 to 141. First category, House bills on third reading uncontested calendar. Calendar, there are 108 bills spread from pages 1 through 53.

[00:23:57] And in lieu of everyone's time and my ability to read numbers quickly, it's going to be taken up as a block, just one big block. pages 1 through 53, House Bills on Third Reading Uncontested. That block is now before the esteemed members of the Virginia House of Delegates, the oldest continuously elected lawmaking body in the new world.

[00:24:27] The delegate from Hampton, Delegate Ward. Mr. Speaker, are we now in the fourth hour? If you would like to, you can make the motion to move us back to the fourth morning hour. We went through it. If you don't hit the button, we keep it moving. All right. Well, the button is pressed. All right, Mr. Speaker, I ask that we move back to the fourth morning for a point of personal privilege.

[00:24:50] The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, today and members of the House, I want to speak my point of personal privilege. I'd like to honor the legacy of black midwives who carried life through some of the darkest moments in American history.

[00:25:08] Midwives, as well as doulas, hold a very special place in my heart. Midwifery among African Americans were female-dominated family profession. Knowledge was sacred. It was passed down from mother to daughter, from grandmother to granddaughter.

[00:25:25] It was more than a skill. It was a calling. It combined medical knowledge, herbal remedies, spiritual practices, and deep community trust. In many ways, midwifery and spirituality were one and the same.

[00:25:43] Now, during slavery, African-American midwives were essential members of their communities. Though enslaved themselves, they held their respective positions among enslaved people. They were healers. They were caretakers. They were counselors, and they were protectors of life.

[00:26:01] Slave owners relied on these women. They used these medical professionals to ensure health of enslaved women who were forced to reproduce. Healthy births meant expanding the labor force. Enslaved women's bodies were treated as property.

[00:26:21] And midwives were expected to safeguard that slaveholders saw as economic investment. Newborn infants will one day become a part of the labor pool. So these midwives not only delivered the babies for the slave woman and perhaps her husband, but she was also delivering the babies that were fathered by the slaveholders.

[00:26:54] Throughout this rural and remote parts of the South, African-American midwives served both black and white women. These women delivered generations into this world.

[00:27:12] They reduced infant mortality. They provided comfort, safety, and dignity in childbirth. They were pillars of the community. Despite later efforts in the early 20th century to discredit and push midwives out of the practice through medical licensing laws and racial bias, their impact cannot be erased.

[00:27:37] the legacy of black midwives lives on. They live on in the life of Claudine Curry-Smith. She was a prominent African-American midwife and a community figure from Northern Neck region of Virginia, specifically Lancaster County.

[00:27:55] Her career spanned more than three decades when she delivered more than 500 babies. Despite the practicing in homes that were often without running water or electricity, she never lost a mother in her care.

[00:28:12] I hope that you agree that the midwife's knowledge, resilience, and spiritual grounding continue to inspire those who carry this sacred work forward today. Every modern midwife, every birth worker who centers compassion, culture, and community stands on the shoulders of these women that

came before them. Black midwives during slavery were more than just attendants at birth. They were guardians of life in a system built on dehumanization. They preserved

[00:28:48] African traditions of healing. They embodied strength, wisdom, and quiet resistance. They were healers in a system that denied their humanity. Their hands caught more than just babies. They carried hope. Their legacy lives on in every midwife who honors ancestral knowledge, community care, and the sacredness of life. So during this month, Black History Month, please remember the legacy of black midwives during slavery and beyond. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:29:32] The delegate from Henrico, Delegate Navarre. Mr. Speaker, I'd like to move back to the fourth morning hour for a point of personal privilege.

[00:29:50] The Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today marks the beginning of Lunar New Year, a holiday celebrated by Chinese, Korean, Vietnamese, Mongolian, Tibetan, and many Southeast Asian communities to welcome the spring season and a new beginning.

[00:30:07] The Lunar New Year is filled with familiar symbols, red for luck and joy, the lion dance, firecrackers, and the 12-year cycle of animals. Today, we enter the year of the horse, a year associated with energy, freedom, and bold action.

[00:30:23] You'll notice on your desk small hanging ornaments with symbols of good fortune offered as we welcome the new year together. For thousands of years, Lunar New Year has reminded us of the importance of family, the power of renewal, and the promise that each year brings new beginnings.

[00:30:39] It also teaches us that just as the moon moves through its phases, our lives, both personal and collective, move through the cycles of growth, struggle, and change. In that spirit, we pause to honor those who came before us.

[00:30:56] In 1587, in the year of the pig, Filipino sailors crossed the Pacific and set foot on this land, becoming the first recorded Asians to arrive in what would one day become the United States. decades before Jamestown. From the very beginning, our presence has been a part of America's story.

[00:31:16] History, like the lunar calendar, does not move in straight lines. In the year of the snake in 1869, Chinese immigrants laid steel across mountains to complete the transcontinental railroad, even as they were denied belonging. In the year of the horse in 1882, their exclusion was written into law. And again, in the year of the horse, 1942, Japanese-American families were imprisoned behind barbed wire, not for what they had done, but for who they were. Even in those years,

[00:31:51] change still came. In the year of the sheep, 1943, exclusion was repealed. In the year of the dog, in 1946, Filipino and Indian immigrants were allowed to claim citizenship. In the year of the in 1965, America dismantled race-based immigration quotas. In the Year of the Monkey in 1980, the Refugee Act affirmed compassion as national policy. And in the Year of the Dog in 1982, the killing of Vincent Chin transformed grief into a civil rights movement that refused invisibility. Here in Virginia, that arc

[00:32:30] bent closer to representation. In the Year of the Ox in 2009, former delegate Mark King became the first Korean American and Asian-born immigrant elected to state government. In the year of the rooster in 2017, our own delegate Cathy Tran became the first Vietnamese American elected to the General Assembly. And in the year of the tiger in 2022, our own delegate Irene Shin became the first Korean

American woman elected, expanding who could see themselves reflected in these halls. And so today, in the year of the horse, in the oldest continuously

[00:33:05] operating lawmaking body in the Western Hemisphere, I stand here humbled as the first Chinese American ever elected to state government in the Commonwealth, not as an ending, but as a continuation of their progress. This is not my achievement alone, but the result of generations who endured hardship, built community, and believed their children could stand where they could not.

[00:33:30] Moments like these invite us not to only reflect on how far we've come, but to look ahead to what comes next. The Spring Festival is a time to hope. The horse calls us to move forward with courage. I believe we can rise to that call. Building on a fairer economy, safer communities, stronger schools, broader access to care and a more inclusive Commonwealth. After a long winter, people gather, celebrate and begin again. Let us all share goodwill, extend happiness and step into to the new year together.

[00:34:06] Happy New Year, wishing you all prosperity.

[00:34:22] - The delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Bennett Parker. - Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I ask that we return to the fourth morning hour for a point of personal privilege. - The delegate has the floor. - Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today, after what someone told me feels like the longest walk-off ever, is my last day in the house. I know I'm not going very far, and yet it somehow feels very far.

[00:34:41] It has been an honor and a privilege to serve in this chamber, the oldest continuously operating legislative body the Western Hemisphere. And when I think back on my time in the House, a few things come to mind. One is that some of the best people I've ever known serve in this body. I'm grateful to everyone who has helped mentor me and answer my questions, everyone who has served with kindness and gratitude, Mr. Speaker, everyone who shows up with genuine care for their communities and constituents, and everyone who has commiserated with me when our bills have met an untimely fate.

[00:35:11] I'm also incredibly grateful to the people who help us serve. Thank you, Mr. Clerk, for all you do and your incredible team from IT to journal and records and everyone who makes the house run so smoothly. And thank you to the folks who serve us in other ways like Chris in the lounge who always make sure I'm hydrated. Thank you to my staff. I wouldn't be here without them. Kelsey Wright is brilliant and dedicated and I'm eternally grateful to her. And I'm also fortunate to work with Caleb Fulford, Alex Campbell, Jess Monroe-Ponce, and our wonderful AA Joanna McKee. Thank you to my family, especially my husband Stephen. One of the most defining aspects of the past four years was

[00:35:47] that I became a mom in this body. My daughter is now a little over two and a half, and she is incredible. She inspires me every day to do this work, to help shape the Virginia I want her and other children to have. And because two things can simultaneously be true, the fact that she is now over 100 miles away from me, which in Nova Miles is two and a half hours home, makes this job much more difficult than it used to be. Thank you, Mr. Speaker, for your leadership in making it easier for parents to serve in this body, and I look forward to continuing to work with you to make the General Assembly more family-friendly. Thank you to all of my fellow parents in the house.

[00:36:26] We have more moms serving than ever before, and we have more parents of babies and toddlers serving than ever before. We have bonded over the challenges of teething, sleep regressions, and illnesses, while also managing the long days and nights of session. It's not easy for any parent to miss the

firsts, the birthdays, the competitions, and accomplishments of our kids, But we make those sacrifices because we know how much this work matters.

[00:36:52] Having members with a variety of backgrounds and experiences that reflect those of our fellow Virginians helps us make better policy decisions for our Commonwealth. And I am so grateful to have learned from all of you in my time here. Mr. Speaker, I promise to never forget where I came from. And I look forward to killing your bills.

[00:37:08] I mean, continuing to work with all of you on the other side. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Just going down the hall, bro.

[00:37:34] The delegate from Prince William, delegate Maldonado. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Arise for the point of personal privilege. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, today is a happy, sad day when we get to honor and celebrate our esteemed friend and colleague and champion and leader.

[00:37:55] That is Delegate Elizabeth Bennett Parker, soon to be Senate Bennett Parker. I want to say a little bit about her because what we have witnessed and what she went through today, How she thanked everybody is who she is.

[00:38:12] The thanking, the gratitude is a reflection of what she has always done in this body, what she has always done for other people, and what she has done for the least of us and the most of us and everybody in between. And what is most inspiring is that her desire, her passion, her will, her drive to make this place and this body better than when she entered is remarkable.

[00:38:39] She helped to modernize this body by helping us to be engaged in conversations about how do we make things easier for people who are pregnant during session, for people who give birth during session, people who are parents of children of all stages, regardless of whether they're moms or dads.

[00:38:58] and having the ability to have people connect to what that means to serve. Because we all sacrifice here, but parents and those who are caretakers of others have a unique experience in this body.

[00:39:13] I also want to say that her modernization of this body doesn't stop with what happens behind the scenes. It has happened with the kind of legislation that she's brought forward, from helping people with differing abilities, from voting to rights across the spectrum.

[00:39:31] There is no stone or place that's untouched by her amazing character and heart and intelligence and diligence. And I will tell you, as somebody who has not only been a seatmate all this time, a classmate, but also a housemate, I see that her care doesn't stop when we leave this floor.

[00:39:52] It is every day, all day, all week, all year long. And this is a great gift that she brings to wherever she goes. And I just know that she'll do an amazing job over at the Senate. We will miss her.

[00:40:08] I will miss her personally. And I cannot wait to see what she does next. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Just remember, all the things we said in caucus about the Senate, it's not true.

[00:40:29] We take it all back. Delegate from Colonial Heights, Delegate Cherry. Mr. Speaker, a quick point of personal privilege. The delegate has the floor. thank you mr speaker um i'd be remiss not to stand up and and say goodbye to uh what's become a very good friend of mine as she departs this chamber for the lesser chamber down the hall in that respect we bonded as we came into the house together over local government both having served in local government understanding that this place is is a terrible model

for how to do government because we keep telling localities what to do and not funding them to do those things And we bonded over the fact that we would never vote for an unfunded mandate.

[00:41:07] I've kept mine. I'm not sure she has, but we'll let her figure that out when she gets down the hall. Recently, she and I were speaking together at Girl State down at Longwood University. And as we often do, we were sparring back and forth on policy and talking about the differences and how we would do things if we were in charge.

[00:41:27] And I left that day, and she stayed a little bit longer and went to lunch. And she relayed the story to me later that as they were eating lunch, one of the girls there said that we had restored her faith in government because we were able to debate policy without it becoming personal, to talk about the things we find dear without it being something that we fought about.

[00:41:51] And so with that, as you depart this body to go down the hall, thank you for always being who you are and doing things the way you did things. And I think you're an example of how we should all represent our communities. Thank you. Clerk will call to Callen.

[00:42:15] Mr. Speaker, members of the House, calendar for today, Tuesday, February 17th, 2026, crossover day. Last day for each House can work on its own legislation except for the budget bills. First category, House bills on third reading uncontested calendar block, spread across pages 1 through 53.

[00:42:32] There are 180 bills, 108 bills in there. Mr. Speaker, all of the bills are in the block, and that large block is now before you. Shall the bills pass?

[00:42:56] Close the roll. Ayes 97, nos 0. Ayes 97, nos 0. The bill's passed. Continuing with today's calendar, we come next to page 53 to begin working through the 156 bills on third reading, final passage, regular calendar.

[00:43:21] First bill in this new category is Delegate McClure's House Bill 524, related to tourism improvement districts, administrating nonprofits, county manager plan, transient occupancy tax. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[00:43:47] Ayes, 68, noes, 28. Ayes, 68, noes, 28. The bill passes. Over on page 54, we have House Bill 936, which relates to enforcement of parking violations, certain counties, pilot program. Shall the bill pass?

[00:44:05] Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 48, noes, 37.

[00:44:20] Ayes, 48, noes, 37. The bill passes. House Bill 26 now before you relates to a modification of sentence for marijuana-related offenses. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:44:43] Ayes 63, noes 34. Ayes 63, noes 34. The bill passes. House Bill 61, now before you, relates to the Department of Small Business and Supplier Diversity, Small Swim Business Procurement Enhancement Program established. Shall the bill pass?

[00:45:08] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 64, noes 33. Ayes 64, noes 33. The bill passes. House Bill 86 relates to Mattress Stewardship Program established. Report. Shall the bill pass?

[00:45:33] Clerk will close the vote. Ayes. 67, noes. 30. Ayes 67, noes. 30. The bill passes. Over on page 56, we come to House Bill 92, which relates to public schools, standards of quality, certain calculations, at-risk program established, state funded special education add-on.

[00:45:51] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the vote. Ayes 94, noes 3. The bill passes.

[00:46:08] Bill 173 now before you relates to state correctional facilities, visitation policies, annual report. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:46:24] Ayes 65, no's 31. Ayes 65, no's 31. The bill passes. House Bill 178 relates to public schools, student support agencies, memoranda of understanding. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:46:49] Ayes 60, no's 35. Ayes 60, no's 35. The bill passes. House Bill 246 is legislation relating to affirmative defense or reduced penalty for mental illness, neurocognitive disorder, or intellectual or developmental disability.

[00:47:06] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the vote. Ayes 56, noes 39. Ayes 56, noes 39, the bill passes.

[00:47:22] On page 58, third reading regular, we come to House Bill 260, which relates to a prevailing wage rate, underground infrastructure work, public service companies. Shall the bill pass?

[00:47:42] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes, 62, noes, 35. Ayes, 62, noes, 35. The bill passes. House Bill 299 relates to the Board of Education, Standards of Learning Assessments, and Related Assessment Methods, Development Administration, Scoring, and Release.

[00:47:59] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes, 86, noes, 11.

[00:48:14] Ayes, 86, noes, 11. The bill passes. House Bill 60, excuse me, page 60, House Bill 318 before you relates to the Virginia Parole Board, Powers and Duties, juvenile offenders, parole procedures, and considerations. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:48:39] Ayes, 67, no's 29. Ayes, 67, no's 29. The bill passes. House Bill 328 relates to the Bureau of Insurance, Essential Health Benefits, Benchmark Plan, Selection. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:49:02] Ayes, 72, no's 25. Ayes, 72, no's 25. The bill passes. Page 62, we come to House Bill 361, which relates to earned sentence credits, incarceration while awaiting trial or pending an appeal. Shall the bill pass?

[00:49:23] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes, 69, noes 27. Ayes, 69, noes 27, the bill passes. House Bill 374 relates to a Manufactured Home Lot Rental Act. Shall the bill pass?

[00:49:45] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes, 61, noes 35. Ayes, 61, noes 35, the bill passes. House Bill 400 relates to Motion Picture Production Tax Credit, Fundset.

[00:50:02] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the vote. Ayes, 74, noes, 23. Ayes, 74, noes, 23. The bill passes.

[00:50:20] House Bill 404, now before you, relates to enslaved and sisters College Access Scholarship and Memorial Program Scholarships Administration Online Portal. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the vote.

[00:50:40] Ayes, 67, noes, 27. Ayes, 67, noes, 27. The bill passes. House Bill 425 relates to the Department of Medical Assistance Services, remote monitoring services through pregnancy and postpartum for high-risk pregnant patients and patients with advanced maternal age reimbursement.

[00:50:58] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the vote. Ayes. 95, no's 1.

[00:51:14] Ayes, 95, no's 1. The bill passes. House Bill 438 relates to a delinquency petition, referral to a court service unit. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the vote.

[00:51:33] Ayes, 63, noes, 33. Ayes, 63, noes, 33. The bill passes. House Bill 444 relates to the Uniform Consumer Debt Default Judgment Act established. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:51:56] Ayes, 76, noes, 21. Ayes, 76, noes, 21. The bill passes. House Bill 461 before you now relates to special education, student age range restrictions in educational settings. Shall the bill pass?

[00:52:15] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 69, noes 28. Ayes 69, noes 28. The bill passes. House Bill 495 relates to school boards, mental health awareness training, full-time school bus drivers.

[00:52:34] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 62, noes 34. Ayes 62, noes 34. The bill passes.

[00:52:51] House Bill 497 would direct each school division superintendent to annually collect, summarize, and report certain data on determination of student eligibility for special education and related services. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:53:12] Ayes 71, no's 26. Ayes 71, no's 26. The bill passes. House Bill 507 relates to permit requirements for data centers, emission limits for certain engine generator sets. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:53:36] Ayes 61, no's 34. Ayes 61, no's 34. The bill passes. House Bill 527 relates to the Department of Housing and Community Development Eviction Reduction Program report. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[00:54:01] Ayes. 64, no's 33. Ayes. 64, no's 33. The bill passes. House Bill 590 relates to Smart Solar Permitting Platform Established Residential Solar Energy Systems. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[00:54:23] Ayes. 61, no's 34. Ayes. 61, no's 34. The bill passes. House Bill 597 now before he relates to Wildlife Corridor Grant Fund established. Voluntary contributions report. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:54:45] Ayes 65, noes 32. Ayes 65, noes 32. The bill passes. Over on page 70, we come to House Bill 614, which would require the Commission on Citizens Education to review and make recommendations on the inclusion of the contributions, perspective, and experiences of historically marginalized communities in the history and social studies, a Social Science Standards of Learning and Curriculum Framework report.

[00:55:10] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes. 61, no's 35. Ayes, 61, no's 35.

[00:55:26] The bill passes. House Bill 637 relates to possession of a residue of a controlled substance, penalties, exceptions. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:55:44] Ayes. 63, no's 33. Ayes, 63, no's 33. The bill passes. House Bill 642 relates to cannabis control, retail market penalties. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Cresick. Thank you, Mr. Speaker, speaking to the bill.

[00:56:01] Delegate has the floor. House Bill 642 is about fixing a status quo that is not working. In fact, it's a mess. Right now, adult possession of cannabis is legal, but sales are unregulated, and that means no testing, no standards, and no oversight whatsoever.

[00:56:19] This bill will replace that gray market. It's a $5 billion illegal market out there with a regulated system that protects public health with testing, labeling, packaging, and strong enforcement and penalties and keeps products away from minors.

[00:56:36] It also takes a careful phased approach so that the CCA, the Cannabis Control Authority, has the time to implement the law responsibly. It allows local control with full zoning authority over where and how retail stores operate responsibly.

[00:56:52] And it creates real opportunities for small businesses and communities, especially those that were disproportionately harmed by past enforcement. This is a measured, responsible step forward. I ask for your support. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[00:57:20] Ayes 65, noes 32. Ayes 65, noes 32. The bill passes. Over on page 72, we come to House Bill 672, which relates to appliance, minimum energy, and water conservation standards, heating, ventilation, and air conditioning facilities, and home appliances, Department of Energy.

[00:57:40] The delegate from Rockingham, Delegate Runyon. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, speaking to the bill. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 672 misaligns Virginia with future appliance efficiency federal standards. This bill will create a patchwork of regulations, reduces options for consumers, increases purchase costs, and creates market confusion.

[00:58:01] Mr. Speaker, affordability matters to the families we represent every day. Today, we can put the consumer first, let the free market decide, and vote no on this bill. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Prince William, Delegate Martinato. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speaking to the bill.

[00:58:18] Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. To be clear, as we vote on this bill today, what we need to know is that the federal government in this moment, as it has done with a number of federal standards, is rolling things back. If you think about the appliances you have in your home, your dishwashers, your refrigerators, your microwaves, they are high energy efficiency appliances.

[00:58:40] What we are doing with this bill is keeping things status quo, which means stability. If we were to allow for us to do nothing and the federal guidelines are rolled back, we could have a flood of non-high energy efficiency appliances come into Virginia.

[00:58:59] And what does that mean? Mr. Speaker, that means high utility bills. High utility bills. We cannot do that. So this bill is about stability. This bill is about affordability. And this bill is about making sure Virginians can do and live in the best way.

[00:59:14] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes, 62, noes, 35.

[00:59:33] Ayes, 62, noes, 35. The bill passes. Over on page 73, House Bill 675 relates to protection of employees, coercion, or threat based on immigration status, civil penalty. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:59:58] Ayes, 61, noes, 36. Ayes, 61, noes, 36. The bill passes. House Bill 686 would require the Department of Education and Development make available to each school board guidance on best practices relating to open school enrollment policies. Shall the bill pass?

[01:00:15] The delegate clerk will close the roll. Ayes 85, noes 11.

[01:00:30] Ayes 85, noes 11. The bill passes. Over on page 74, we come to House Bill 707. Relates to state government, transaction of public business, prohibited website domain. Delegate from Chesapeake, delegate Hayes. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 707 is about trust, security, and consistency.

[01:00:51] When a Virginian sees a .gov or .edu website, they know it is legitimate, not a spoof page designed to steal their information. These domains are not self-assigned. They require formal federal vetting through CISA, the Cybersecurity Infrastructure Security Agency, for .gov and accreditation verification for .edu.

[01:01:17] Mr. Speaker, I want to apologize to the entire body here because I shared in committee and on the floor that it would cost you a measly $400 and 30 days to register your localities.gov domain.

[01:01:34] The truth is, Mr. Speaker, CISA has waived the actual costs and that the cost for that is actually free. So for free, your locality can register its domain for free.

[01:01:55] Your locality can register its domain for free, the third time's a charm, Mr. Speaker. Your locality can register its domain for free and get a response back approval within 10 days, 10 days.

[01:02:12] And at a time when phishing attacks and government impersonation scams are rising, this is a cybersecurity measure, not just branding. For free, we strengthen public trust, reduce fraud, and create a uniform statewide standard.

[01:02:29] Virginia should lead in cybersecurity, not lag. I hope it's the will of the body to pass the bill. Shall the bill pass?

[01:02:49] Close the row. Ayes 54, nose 43. Ayes 54, nose 43. The bill passes. House Bill 786 will be taken up with later in the calendar, so continuing, third reading, final passage, regular calendar, page 75.

[01:03:07] House Bill 796, now before you, relates to professions and occupations, adjustment of fees by regulatory boards, recovery of disciplinary and monitoring costs. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:03:30] Ayes 68, noes 28. Ayes 68, noes 28, the bill passes. House Bill 836 relates to public schools' right to free public elementary and secondary education, discrimination based on immigration status prohibited requirements.

[01:03:49] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 61, noes 34.

[01:04:05] Ayes 61, noes 34. The bill passes. House Bill 894 relates to private elementary and secondary schools' student codes of conduct, policies related to bullying and cyberbullying requirements. Shall the bill pass?

[01:04:28] Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 73, noes, 24. 73, noes, 24. The bill passes. That's bill 895 relates to Electric Utilities, Energy Storage Resources, Department of Energy to develop model ordinances, work group reports.

[01:04:46] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 65, noes, 32.

[01:05:02] Ayes, 65, noes, 32. The bill passes. House Bill 896 relates to substantial risk orders, substantial risk order training program established, annual report. Shall the bill pass?

[01:05:23] Clerk will close the row. Ayes. 61, noes 35. Ayes 61, noes 35, the bill passes. House Bill 901 relates to substantial risk orders, eligible petitioners, substantial risk factors and considerations, court jurisdiction, constructive possession of firearms, penalty.

[01:05:40] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes. Ayes 62, noes 34. Ayes 62, Nose 34. The bill passes.

[01:05:58] House Bill 913 would require the Superintendent of Public Instruction to reverse certain recent actions and restore certain rescinded resources. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:06:18] Ayes 62, Nose 35. Ayes 62, Nose 35. The bill passes. House Bill 969 would direct the Department of Criminal Justice Services to clean a workgroup to develop policy and legislative recommendations to address firearm violence. Shall the bill pass?

[01:06:38] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 61, noes 35. Ayes 61, noes 35, the bill passes. House Bill 971 relates to college student-athletes, biometric data, protections, and limitations.

[01:06:58] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 93, noes 3.

[01:07:15] Ayes 93, noes 3, the bill passes. House Bill 974 now before you relates to witness impeachment evidence designation review process. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[01:07:37] Ayes, 64, noes, 33. Ayes, 64, noes, 33. The bill passes. Over on page 80, third reading regular, we come to House Bill 1015, which relates to possession or transportation of firearms, firearms, ammunitions, stun weapons, or explosive or carrying of concealed weapons by persons convicted of a misdemeanor hate crime prohibited penalty.

[01:08:01] Shall the bill pass? Turk will close the roll. Ayes, 60, noes, 35.

[01:08:18] Ayes, 60, noes, 35. The bill passes. House Bill 1016 is legislation relating to Virginia Cooperative Extension Service, cats and dogs, list of toxic houseplants. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:08:46] Ayes 66, noes 30. Ayes 66, noes 30. The bill passes. House Bill 1070 relates to a procedure for use of prior adjudication, conviction, or status as element of offense charged. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:09:10] Ayes 60, noes 35. Ayes 60, noes 35. The bill passes. House Bill 1072 relates to local authority to test and monitor the land application of sewage sludge within its political boundaries. Shall the bill pass?

[01:09:33] Clerk will close the row. Ayes 62, noes 34. Ayes 62, noes 34. The bill passes. House Bill 1111 relates to civil litigation, suspension bonds, and irrevocable letters of credit upon appeal.

[01:09:53] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 69, noes 28. Ayes 69, noes 28, the bill passed.

[01:10:09] House Bill 1152 relates to Department of Environmental Quality, Carbon, Market Participation, Coastal and Marine Resources. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:10:30] Ayes 89, noes 7. Ayes 89, noes 7, the bill passed. House Bill 1186 would require the Department of Education to collect information on the use of artificial intelligence systems for students' instruction in each local school division and any school board policies governing such use.

[01:10:47] report. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 95, no's 1. Ayes 95, no's 1. The bill passes. House Bill 1217 relates to keeper of a library stable liens requirements. Shall the

[01:11:13] bill pass? The clerk will close the row. Ayes 87, no's 10. Ayes 87, no's 10. Over on page 84 we come to House Bill 1229, which would require the Department of Education to take certain actions

[01:11:51] related to the use of seclusion and restraint in public schools report. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:12:07] Ayes 92, excuse me, Ayes 90, Noes 7. Ayes 90, Noes 7, the bill passes. House Bill 1241 would direct the Hempton Roads Planning District Commission to develop an infrastructure coordination and fiscal readiness framework for Planning District 23.

[01:12:24] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 92, noes 5.

[01:12:39] Ayes 92, noes 5. The bill passes. House Bill 1249 relates to the Virginia Innovation Partnership Authority, Creative Economy Task Force established, strategic plan report sunset. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:13:02] Ayes 91, noes 6. Ayes 91, noes 6. The bill passes. House Bill 1280 relates to state correctional facilities, participation of prisoners in employment and educational programs, re-entry planning work group report. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 91, noes 5. Ayes 91, noes 5. The bill passes. House bill 1283 relates to high school

[01:13:38] graduation requirements and diploma pathways implementation. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 96, noes 1. Ayes 96, noes 1. The bill passes. House bill House Bill 1320 relates to unemployment benefits, increased weekly benefit amounts.

[01:14:08] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 62, noes 35. Ayes, 62, noes 35.

[01:14:24] The bill passes. House Bill 1345 relates to public schools, indoor air quality, industry recognized uniform inspection and evaluation. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[01:14:43] Ayes, 61, noes 35. Ayes, 61, noes 35. The bill passes. House Bill 1352, now before he relates to driver education, dangers of reckless driving, including driving at excessive speeds. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:15:09] Ayes 95, noes 1. Ayes 95, noes 1, the bill passes. House Bill 1365 relates to fishing license requirements, exemptions, free fishing day. The delegate from Roanoke, Delegate Rasul.

[01:15:25] Thank you, Mr. Speaker, speaking to the bill. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. This is the time where if you need to take a restroom break, you can go and do that for just a quick moment. I'd like to speak to the bill, Mr. Speaker, because I don't understand why we need six days instead of three. And if we were on second read, I would ask the patron, as I really looked at this bill further, to try to determine if this made a lot of sense. You know, if he needs six full days, Mr. Speaker, then that would mean

[01:16:03] that's more than a week of free fishing days so i can't ask the patron any questions mr speaker but if i could i would ask him why he needed six instead of three so i just ask everyone to question supporting this bill mr speaker while everyone is trying to make sure that they get a stretch in

[01:16:25] the house will be at ease the house will come to order the delegate from here right go delegate

[01:32:00] willett thank you mr speaker i'd like us to return to the first morning hour for the purpose of an introduction. Doug, it has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Joining us at the Capitol today are athletes from Sportable Adaptive Sports. You may have seen and met some of them this morning at the breakfast they hosted. They're here in the Capitol today to advocate for the expansion of sports and wellness

programs for disabled individuals throughout the Commonwealth. As Virginia's premier adaptive sports club, Sportable provides sports and wellness opportunities to more than 400 athletes annually through a variety of competitive and recreational adaptive programs.

[01:32:37] Their athletes' range and age come from diverse backgrounds, possess varying abilities. I met some of the athletes this morning. We had tennis players, pickleball players, lacrosse players, rugby players, basketball players. It's amazing. By fostering a fun, inclusive, and competitive and accessible environment, they transform our athletes' lives, free them to see beyond their disabilities, enhance their peer relationships, and help them reach their personal finish lines.

[01:33:03] I hope that you will join me in giving them a warm house welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. I believe we were on HB 1365.

[01:33:21] Shall the bill pass? Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Roanoke, Delegate McNamara. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speaking to the bill. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speaking to the bill and indirectly answering the questions of my fellow delegate from Roanoke City, when we, in this chamber, we are going to, we're in the process and will likely continue the process of having paid time off of 12 weeks and paid sick leave of one hour for every 30 hours.

[01:33:53] So we're going to have a lot of extra time, and people are going to have more time to go fishing. So if we really want to make Virginia affordable, we certainly don't want to charge them for those extra days that they might be fishing. I encourage all of my fellow delegates to support this bill. The delegate from Hanover, Delegate Fowler.

[01:34:15] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Let me see. I will be brief. I know that's a challenge, but, Mr. Speaker, I think the first time my father took me fishing, I think I was probably five years old.

[01:34:33] And I've loved fishing for my entire life, and I still do an awful lot of it. And I guess, Mr. Speaker, you know, all I really want is for young people to have all the same fun that I have. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Aww. Shall the bill pass?

[01:35:00] Fun haters. The clerk will close the row.

[01:35:13] Ayes 92. Noes 4. Ayes 92. Noes 4. House continuing third reading regular bottom of page 88. We now come to House Bill 1374 relating to the Virginia Military Institute Board of Visitors membership. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 69. Noes 28. Ayes 69. Noes 28. The bill passes.

[01:35:44] House Bill 1385 relates to gubernatorial appointments, confirmation process, Virginia Commission on Higher Education Board appointments, membership duties, and committees of legal counsel for governing boards of public institutions of higher education. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:36:08] Ayes 62, noes 35. Ayes 62, noes 35. The bill passes. House Bill 1387 relates to the Board of Education, automatic revocation of teacher licenses upon certain convictions. Shall the bill pass?

[01:36:32] Clerk will close the row. Ayes 97, no zero. Ayes 97, no zero. The bill passes. On page 90 of the printed calendar, third reading record, we come to House Bill 1391 related to Sickle Cell Coordinated Access Network Established. Shall the bill pass?

[01:36:50] Clerk will close the row. Ayes 95, no zero. Ayes 95, no zero. The bill passes. House Bill 1396 relates to the Department of Wildlife Resources permits, use of dogs and hunting game animals, fur-

bearing animals, And nuisance species, civil penalties.

[01:37:13] Delegate from Sussex, Delegate Waxman. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I would like to speak to the bill. The delegate has the floor. Thank you. Yesterday, there was a question about how many violations has occurred in the state of Virginia. And I recall that a few months ago, I had a conversation with somebody with DWR, and I was given a sheet, but it took me a while to find it.

[01:37:35] I couldn't find it yesterday, Mr. Speaker. in 2023 i'm told the total dwr carls was 6128 of those 327 were related to hunting dogs in 24 it was 6089 271 were related to hunting dog violations and last year it was 6661 of those were 163 mr speaker it's gone down the last three years from 5.3 percent to 4.4

[01:38:09] To 2.4 percent. I just wanted to give that information to my fellow delegates to keep that in mind. Thank you mr.

[01:38:16] Speaker. Shall the bill pass. Mr. Speaker I'd like to speak to the bill please. Oh destroy the roll. You didn't hit it. You didn't hit your button. Thank you. Mr. Speaker. Delegate. Delegate Wright. Thank you. I'll be brief. Mr. Speaker I'd like to just say to the body. I've received more emails probably on this bill than anyone this year. It affects my area more so probably than

[01:38:51] most of you because I live in a rural area and hound hunting is a way of life for a lot of people. We do respect landowners and their rights, and some improvements need to be made in that. However, I think this bill goes too far. It's going to have a severe hardship on families that love to hunt as a unit and enjoy their hunting dogs. It's going to affect the local economies in my area because of small stores that sell gas and food and days when people

[01:39:29] hunt. Also, the dogs are well taken care of. They require collars, of course, food, veterinary services, and it's going to be a real impact on us. I've heard from small store owners. I've heard from the families. I've heard from the hunt clubs, and we need to improve the relations with the landowners and that's one thing that needs to be worked on but I think this this bill for the problem that exists I think this bill is way too radical and out of just I'm against it and I'd appreciate the body taking a second

[01:40:03] thought about it thank you very much the delegate from Richmond City delegate Smith speaking to Bill mr. speaker very briefly the delegate is full sorry I wasn't gonna say anything but um I would just like to say that I do not live in a rural district of course but I have many friends and visit them and I I have actually witnessed problems of this sort, and we are headed towards something really disastrous because we have no regulations, and I have had friends had to deal with the conflict and the confrontation that happens.

[01:40:38] So I would urge my fellow members to please vote for the bill so that we can become the last state to regulate this. And I appreciate the delegate for bringing the bill. Thank you. Shall the bill pass?

[01:41:02] Clerk will close the row. Ayes 55, noes 39. Ayes 55, noes 39. The bill passes. House Bill 1398 relates to the fetal and infant mortality review team established penalty and report.

[01:41:20] The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, speaking to the bill. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I just hope the folks will think long and hard about this bill before they vote yes. This is someone's very important first bill, but I hope we'll think very long and hard about whether we want to really vote yes for this bill or not.

[01:41:36] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill pass?

[01:41:55] Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 92, no's 5. Ayes, 92, no's 5. The bill passes. House Bill 1401 relates to eminent domain, certificate of take, description of property.

[01:42:15] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 93, no's 4.

[01:42:31] Ayes, 93, no's 4. The bill passes. Over on page 92 of today's calendar, third reading regular, we come to House Bill 1403, which relates to severe maternal morbidity, surveillance, and review program established. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[01:42:55] Ayes, 95, no's 2. Ayes, 95, no's 2. The bill passes. House Bill 1418 relates to sickle cell trait awareness and education program established. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[01:43:20] Ayes, 93, no's 2. Ayes, 93, no's 2. The bill passes. House Bill 1426 relates to limitations on enforcement of judgments docketing of general district court judgments in the circuit court and shall the bill pass clerk will close the row ayes 63 knows 34 ayes 63 knows 34 the bill passes house bill um 90 uh

[01:43:55] excuse me on page 94 house bill 1432 is not before us so next up uh third reading regular is house bill 1443 which relates to owners of sewage treatment works land application marketing or distribution of sewage sludge, perfil-like eye-gold, blah, blah, blah, and substance abuse testing requirements. Work with me. Apologize. Should the bill pass?

[01:44:30] Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 67. Noes, 29. Ayes, 67. Noes, 29. The bill passes. House Bill 1444 relates to the Virginia Clean Energy Innovation Bank. Established a report. Shall the bill pass?

[01:44:54] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 61, noes 34. Ayes 61, noes 34. The bill passes. House Bill 1502, it directs the Department of Environmental Quality to conduct a one-year study of all standby generators used by certain commercial facilities in the Commonwealth and explore ways to address the pollution from such generators report.

[01:45:14] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 61, noes 35. Ayes 61, noes 35. The bill passes.

[01:45:31] House Bill 1503 would require the Superintendent of Public Instruction to issue a superintendent's memo with guidance and resources for public high school athletic coaches on sickle cell trait. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:45:54] Ayes 91, noes 6. Ayes 91, noes 6. The bill passes. House Bill 75 relates to medical cannabis administration to terminally ill patients report. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:46:17] Ayes 95, noes 1. Ayes 95, noes 1. the bill passes. House bill 82 relates to elections deadline for receipt of absentee balance and certain other information 5 p.m. on the third day after the election. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 60, no's 35. Ayes 60, no's 35. The bill passes. House bill 111 relates to voter registration, cancellation of registration, sources of data. Shall the bill

[01:46:54] pass. Turk will close the roll. Ayes 61, noes 35. Ayes 61, noes 35. The bill passes. Over on page 98, we come to House Bill 161, which relates to the Virginia Lottery, casinos, internet gaming, authorized penalties. 161. 161? Yes. Shall the bill pass? Mr. Speaker? Mr. Speaker? The delegate from Buckingham, Deputy Garrett. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speaking of the bill? The delegate has

[01:47:32] the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Sorry. Okay, sorry. I almost did this as a point of personal privilege because I was so terrified that I would get missed. HB 161 is Frankenstein. I don't know how we put it together and it won't die. Don't believe me? It was dead in subcommittee, but here it is. It was dead in

committee, but here it is. I wasn't in the Senate, but apparently it was dead in the Senate yesterday until they pulled it back up a couple of times and finally a couple of members decided to leave the room and it finally passed, I think, 19 to 18. And so everybody said, don't speak on this bill, Garrett, because it's going to die anyway. Well, it was

[01:48:07] going to die anyway three times. Now, I compared this bill to Frankenstein's monster and Frankenstein's monster killed people, killed multiple people. Check it out. Mary Shelley's book, kind of awesome. This bill will kill people. Frankenstein's monster killed people because of revenge. This bill is going to kill people because of greed. What does it do?

[01:48:27] Mark Stewart of the Live Casino website said, please don't put a casino on every single phone, in every single pocket, in every single car. Yay, indeed, in every single middle school. That's what this bill does. This is easily one of the worst bills of this session. And by golly, that's saying something. It targets our young men. And yet, I fear that people who vote for this bill are the very same people that said, hey, we're going to help our young men by having a Virginia Commission on Men and Boys. It specifically targets our young men and their dopamine receptors.

[01:49:01] They have studied this so thoroughly that they understand exactly how to get you to do what they want you to do when you poke your finger on the illuminated screen that is your cell phone. Our young men are in the crosshairs, and it targets our most vulnerable young men. Right now, Already, an estimated 50% of young men between 18 and 49 have these sorts of things on their phone, which brings me to my next point.

[01:49:23] Yesterday, the patron said, oh, well, just to be clear, this already exists in Virginia. All we want to do is tax and regulate it. Well, let me talk about some other things really quickly that already exist in Virginia. Should we tax and regulate human trafficking? Should we tax and regulate heroin? Do we need money so bad that we should tax and regulate fentanyl?

[01:49:39] Should we tax and regulate rape, murder, strong-arm robbery? We don't tax and regulate things that destroy people because our responsibility is to try to form a more perfect union. Not to cater to the basal instincts and the greed of people who wish to make money without regard for human life.

[01:49:59] There's so much. There's so much. My colleague from Newport News, who I respect but don't always agree with, I think really astutely said, you don't even have to have your pants on to gamble with this one. Imagine a college student who's squirreling away money from her summer job to pay for that next semester whose phone vibrates the night before the exam when they just can't sleep.

[01:50:19] And they look at the screen, and it says, your winning streak is waiting. Before their roommate gets out of bed, that next semester's tuition may already be gone. Mr. Speaker, I was told not to say this, but I'm going to say it anyway. The amount of money that was spent by the people who were pushing this legislation numbs the mind.

[01:50:37] It numbs the mind. I'm going to be equal opportunity here. $500,000 to a major political party. $500,000 to a candidate for governor. $500,000 to one party's leadership pack. $300,000 to the other party's leadership pack. $150,000 to a member of leadership of a party, $100,000 to a caucus, $100,000 to an inauguration for a governor, $75,000, it's just this year, $75,000 to a committee chair, $55,000 to a prominent member, $51,000 to the patron of the bill, $50,000 to another member of this body, $50,000 to a senator down the hall, $50,000 to another senator down the hall, $50,000 to a Republican senator.

[01:51:18] Now, listen, I wish they'd have sent me money. I'd have taken it and I'd have voted no on this horrible bill. I don't like to channel people who weren't good people, but the most corrupt politician in American history was right when he said if you can't smoke their free cigars and take their checks and eat their free steak and then the very next day vote and tell them to go to hell, you need to be in another line of work.

[01:51:41] This is an opportunity for us to show that we care more about the people who we're purporting to serve on both sides of the aisle than we do about the people who write us checks. Where has it been tried before?

[01:51:56] They tried this in 23 states last cycle. They were 0 for 23. It was done in the United Kingdom, where one of the major proponents of this bill is based in Ireland right next door. It failed so badly in the United Kingdom that they made it illegal to do what we're trying to do here. And so they shipped it abroad.

[01:52:12] Thanks, England. Pennsylvania passed this legislation. And a few short years later, after there was literally a death toll, and I know y'all are wondering what the heck Garrett's talking about, there was a bipartisan backlash where they put the car in reverse, backed up, and did a U-turn. Why is it going to cost lives?

[01:52:29] Well, the demographics targeted by this particular bill and the people who are putting their money behind it are people who are already accelerated at risk for suicide. And the statistics say that the addiction here is literally, this is Harvard School of Public Policy, 10 times worse than physical casinos, 10 times worse.

[01:52:49] Young men with gambling addictions are 15 times more likely to kill themselves. And the tragedy here, and I feel like I got a crystal ball. I've done this before in politics. I know I'm right. The tragedy here is that this won't play out on a mass scale. This won't be one horrible tragedy where all the people burn down at once.

[01:53:08] This will be a thousand little tragedies. A thousand wives who lose a husband, husbands who lose a wife. A thousand children who don't get to go fishing with that dad because the decisions that he made when someone who had studied on the human brain and dopamine receptors and exactly how they respond to certain stimuli made the decisions that he made and ended up hurting the people that he loved most.

[01:53:34] And I know a little something about that. So I jumped up, Mr. Speaker, to speak to this bill because I've said this a million times. I really just want to live a life where I feel like I can make a difference. And the thing is that we want to make differences, guys, where we get trophies and we get headlines and we get plaudits and we get awards.

[01:53:56] But the way God works, Mr. Speaker, sometimes we help people and we don't get to know about it. Sometimes we save lives of people that we will never meet. Sometimes we preserve families that we don't even know exist. And so, yes, it already exists in Virginia, but so does human trafficking.

[01:54:15] So does fentanyl. We're not going to tax and regulate those. We shouldn't tax and regulate this. This is such a nefarious scheme that when Rolling Stone attempted to shine a light on the addictive behaviors that these companies seek to foster, all the companies behind it refused to comment. So I know I was told, oh, it's going to die, but it was going to die in subcommittee, and then it died, and then it came

back to life, and then it was going to die in committee, and then it died, and then it came back to life, and it was going to die in the Senate, And then it died and members took a walk and it came back to life.

[01:54:44] Let's kill it today. Let's do this together because it's the right thing to do. I don't hold any umbrage to anybody that took a dime from these people. I don't. I would have taken it and I would have still voted no. And I'm asking you guys to do the same thing.

[01:55:01] God bless you. This is a chance to make a difference. I hope we will. Shall the bill pass?

[01:55:28] Close the row. Eyes 46, nose 49. Eyes 46, nose 49. The bill fails. Continuing with. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, having voted on the prevailing side by which we failed to pass House Bill 161, I move that we reconsider that vote.

[01:55:48] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon moves that having voted on the prevailing side by which we failed to pass HB 161, he asked that we reconsider the vote. All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to the Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, move that vote go by temporarily.

[01:56:05] The Delegate moves that HB 161 go by temporarily without objection. Over on page 99, continuing third reading regular, we come to House Bill 193, which relates to parole exception to limitation on the application of parole statutes.

[01:56:23] The delegate, shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 61, noes, 35.

[01:56:41] Ayes, 61, noes, 35. The bill passes. House Bill 215 relates to voter registration, list maintenance, third-party data exchanges, approval by State Board of Elections. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:57:07] Ayes 62, noes 35. Ayes 62, noes 35. The bill passes. Over on page 100, we come to House Bill 294, which relates to malicious bodily injury to correctional officers penalties.

[01:57:22] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 88, noes 8.

[01:57:39] Ayes 88, noes 8. The bill passes. House Bill 295 relates to aggravated murder defined. correctional officers punishment shall the bill pass clerk will close growth eyes 87 no 7 i was 87 no 7 the bill passes hospital to house bill uh 298 relates to a public elementary or secondary

[01:58:13] school students evidence-based restorative disciplinary practices shall the bill pass last clerk will close the roll eyes 62 nose 35 i 62 nose 35 the bill passes house bill uh 319 now Now, before he would direct the Department of Elections to convene a work group on the implementation of back-end opt-out automatic voter registration.

[01:58:49] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 61, noes 35.

[01:59:06] Ayes 61, noes 35. The bill passes. House Bill 360 relates to the Virginia Consumer Protection Act, prohibited practices, Kratom products. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:59:29] Ayes 95, noes 2. Ayes 95, noes 2. The bill passes. House Bill 398 relates to Safeguarding American Veteran Empowerment Act, preventive practices, penalties. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:59:55] Ayes 88, no's 5. Ayes 88, no's 5. The bill passes. House Bill 410 relates to school boards, participation in SAT school day program required, student participation. Shall the bill pass?

[02:00:12] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 88, no's 8.

[02:00:28] Ayes 88, no's 8. The bill passes. House Bill 430, now before you, relates to the new college institute name, membership, and composition of the Board of Directors. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[02:00:51] Ayes 92, noes 5. Ayes 92, noes 5, the bill passes. House Bill 489, it relates to restorative justice practices. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[02:01:13] Ayes 61, noes 36. Ayes 61, noes 36, the bill passes. Page 106, we come to House Bill 490, which relates to health insurance coverage for early refills of prescription eye drops. Shall the bill pass?

[02:01:31] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 93, no's 4. Ayes 93, no's 4, the bill passes. House Bill 496 relates to zoning, commercial and industrial facilities, water use disclosures.

[02:01:48] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 74, no's 23.

[02:02:04] Ayes 74, no's 23, the bill passes. House Bill 505 relates to county, cities, and towns, members of governing body, continuing personal interest in certain transactions. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[02:02:26] Ayes 63, noes 34. Ayes 63, noes 34. The bill passes. House Bill 548 relates to the Uniform Health Care Decisions Act Civil Penalty. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[02:02:49] Ayes 62, noes 34. Ayes 62, noes 34. The bill passes. House Bill 560, now before you, relates to the Administrative Process Act, exemptions, limitations, appeals of case decisions regarding benefits sought.

[02:03:06] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 86, noes 11.

[02:03:22] Ayes 86, noes 11. The bill passes. House Bill 569 is legislation relating to a prevailing wage rate for public works contracts, definition of civil penalty. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[02:03:45] Ayes 62, noes 35. Ayes 62, nose 35, the bill passes. House Bill 591 relates to the policy of the Commonwealth Data Center. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[02:04:10] Ayes 62, nose 34. Ayes 62, nose 34, the bill passes. Page 110, we come to House Bill 602 relating to motion picture theaters, open captioning. Shall the bill pass?

[02:04:32] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 79, nose 17. Ayes 75, nose 59. Ayes 17.

[02:04:48] Ayes 79, noes 17. The bill passes. House Bill 613 relates to the Department of Education, Division of Superintendents, Teacher Recruitment and Retention, Mentorship Pilot Program established, Administration report. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the vote.

[02:05:17] Ayes 63, noes 34. Ayes 63, noes 34. The bill passes. House Bill 630 now before you relates to elections, conduct of elections, ranked choice voting locally elected offices report. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 62, noes 34. Ayes 62, noes 34. The bill passes. House bill 648 relates to the sale

[02:05:55] distribution etc of nitrous oxide prohibitant penalties. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 95, noes 0, abstentions 1. Ayes 95, noes 0, abstentions 1. The bill passes.

[02:06:22] House Bill 684 relates to photo speed monitoring devices, photo monitoring systems for traffic signals, proof of violation, registered conservators of the piece, and technicians employed by a locality. Training. Shall the bill pass?

[02:06:42] Clerk will close the row. Ayes 56, no's 39. Ayes 56, no's 39. The bill passes.

[02:06:57] House Bill 728 would require the State Board of Health to amend regulations for permanent pump and haul of sewage. agritourism. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 82, noes 14. Ayes 82, noes 14. The bill passes. House Bill 735 would direct the Board of Housing and Community Development to review and consider amending regulations for temporary tents used for agritourism purposes. Shall the bill

[02:07:37] pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 87, noes 8. Ayes 87, noes 8. The bill passes. House Bill 765 relates to regulation of rental home marketplace guarantees penalty. Shall the bill pass? Clerk

[02:08:15] will close the roll. Ayes 73, no's 22. Ayes 73, no's 22. The bill passes. House bill 884 relates to electric utilities percentage of income payment program eligibility. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 63, no's 34. Three, no's 34. The bill passes. House bill 897 relates to

[02:08:54] retail sales and use tax exemption for data centers. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 61, noes 34. Ayes 61, noes 34. The bill passes. House bill 911 relates to limited duration licenses and driver privilege cards and permits. Expiration. Shall the bill pass? The delegate from

[02:09:29] Farquhar, Delegate Weber. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise to speak to the bill. Delegate has a floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise respectfully to ask my colleagues to vote no on HB 9-11. Upon hearing the description of the bill and reviewing the language more carefully, I believe this legislation contains two significant flaws, unless my interpretation is incorrect, and I welcome clarification if that's true. First, when Virginia created the driver privilege card program, the General Assembly made a deliberate and careful balance

[02:10:04] policy choice. We extended driving privileges regardless of immigration status, but we required that individuals demonstrate they were contributing to the Commonwealth through tax filing. That verification occurs at renewal. It was not accidental. It was part of the legislative compromise. By extending renewals to eight years and explicitly waiving the tax compliance check, this bill fundamentally alters that bargain. And it does so without a broader policy discussion about whether we intend to change the underlying structure we originally adopted. If we're going to revisit compromise, it deserves open debate, not a quiet modification.

[02:10:40] Second, Mr. Speaker, this bill creates a disparity within our credentialing system that should give us pause. An individual here on a valid work visa with lawful USCIS authorization must renew a limited duration license when that status expires and demonstrate continued legal presence.

[02:11:00] That is a standard applied to those who have followed the immigration process and maintain federal authorization. Yet, under this bill, someone who cannot demonstrate any legal status at all would receive an eight year card with no ongoing verification requirement that means we are imposing stricter renewal standards on individuals complying with immigration law than those who are not whether one

supports the underlying program or not that is a policy choice that deserves careful scrutiny mr. speaker this is not a small technical adjustment it changes the structure and equity of the program we previously enacted for those reasons I respectfully respectfully ask the

[02:11:39] body to vote no on HB 9/11 thank you mr. speaker shall the bill pass Clerk will close the roll.

[02:12:00] Ayes, 60, noes, 34. Ayes, 60, noes, 34. The bill passes. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Rise for a motion. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that the House stand in recess until 12:21.

[02:12:22] The Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring, moves that the House stand in recess until 12:21. All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed? House is in recess until 1221.

[02:21:26] The House will come to order.

[02:27:22] The House will be at ease.

[02:29:36] The House will come to order.

[02:31:51] Mr. Clerk. Excuse me, Mr. Speaker. Members of the House, we continue top of page 116, House Bill's third reading regular. House Bill 934 is now before you. It relates to alcoholics, beverage control, government stores, distillers, licensees, as agents of the board, sale of alcoholic beverages.

[02:32:14] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes. 91, no's 4. Ayes 91, no's 4. The bill passes.

[02:32:31] House Bill 938 is legislation relating to the Department of Environmental Quality, Industrial Wastewater, Publically Owned Treatment Works, PFAS Monitoring. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[02:32:50] Ayes 88, no's 7. Ayes 88, no's 7. The bill passes. House Bill 944 relates to workplace violence policy required for certain employers. Civil penalty. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[02:33:11] Ayes 62, no's 35. Ayes 62, noes 35. The bill passes. House Bill 972 relates to voter registration, list maintenance activities, cancellation procedures, record matches, required identification data standards.

[02:33:28] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 62, noes 35. Ayes 62, noes 35. The bill passes.

[02:33:44] House Bill 994 relates to photos, speed monitoring devices, placement, and operation. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[02:34:01] Ayes. 59, noes 38. Ayes, 59, noes 38. The bill passes. House Bill 998 is legislation relating to menstrual products, ingredient labeling, excuse me, a civil penalty. Shall the bill pass?

[02:34:22] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes, 69, noes 28. Ayes, 69, noes 28. The bill passes. House Bill 1002 relates to certain utilities, notice procedures for nonpayment. Shall the bill pass?

[02:34:42] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes, 62, noes 35. Ayes 62, Nose 35, the bill passes. House Bill 120 relates to consumer protection, automatic renewal, or continuous service offers, disclosure, and cancellation.

[02:35:03] 10-22. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 91, Nose 4.

[02:35:19] Ayes 91, Nose 4, the bill passes. House Bill 1046 relates to Virginia Public Procurement Act, Additional Public Works Contract Requirements. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[02:35:39] Ayes 61, Nose 35. I-61, Nose-35, the bill passed. House Bill 1092 relates to protections of employees, standards for heat illness prevention. Delegate from Scott County, Delegate Kilgore. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speak to the bill. Delegate has the floor.

[02:35:55] Very briefly, Mr. Speaker, ladies and gentlemen of the House, this bill allows an employee to sue an employer. And normally that is a workers' comp issue, and that's how we've always kept these issues in the Commonwealth of Virginia.

[02:36:12] And I hope people will vote no, but I hope as we go through the process that this will get changed back to the workers' compensation law where it should be. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[02:36:37] Ayes 62, noes 35. Ayes 62, noes 35. The bill passes. House Bill 1,151, Relation to Electric Utilities, Duty to Furnish Adequate Service, Delay in Provision of Service. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[02:37:02] Ayes 65, noes 32. Ayes 65, Nose 32. The bill passed. House Bill 1173 relates to the Virginia Human Rights Act, reasonable accommodation for known limitations related to menopause. Report. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 62, Nose 35.

[02:37:29] Ayes 62, Nose 35. The bill passes. Over on page 122, we come to House Bill 1182, which is legislation related to health insurance coverage for contraceptive drugs and devices. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 63, Nose 34.

[02:37:54] 63 notes, 34. The bill passed. House Bill 1207 relates to paid family and medical leave insurance program. Notice requirements, civil action. Shall the bill pass? Oh, the delegate from Fauquier, Delegate Weber. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise to speak to the bill.

[02:38:10] Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I appreciate my colleagues' willingness to find a way for Virginia's employees to care for those they love. That instinct is honorable. But good intentions are not enough, and I believe this legislation will ultimately do more harm than good.

[02:38:27] Let's be clear, it creates a brand new payroll tax on every Virginia worker and every Virginia employer. At a time when families are feeling the effects of inflation and small businesses are fighting to remain competitive, this bill reaches into both sides of the paycheck.

[02:38:43] Workers will see less take-home pay. Employers will face yet another mandate layered on top of an already complex regulatory environment. The impact will not fall evenly. Large corporations may be able to absorb new premium costs and administrative burdens, But for small and mid-sized Virginia businesses, the 20, 50, 100 employee operations that form the backbone of our local economies, this is not a minor adjustment.

[02:39:09] It is a new fixed cost, a new compliance structure, and a new uncertainty in workforce planning. There is also significant ambiguity in the bill itself. It allows paid leave to care for anyone whose, quote, close association is the equivalent of a family relationship.

[02:39:30] What does that mean? A roommate, a long-time friend, a former partner, the language does not define the boundary. Employers will not know the scope until claims begin to be filed. The uncertainty

makes it extremely difficult for businesses to plan staffing, coverage, and operational needs.

[02:39:48] Finally, we must consider the litigation exposure that this bill creates. This proposal does not simply establish a leave program. It creates a new cause of action with damages, attorney's fees, and a three-year statute of limitations for alleged retaliation. Even employers acting in complete good faith could face significant legal exposure.

[02:40:10] Many will settle claims simply to avoid the cost of prolonged litigation. That is not balanced policy. That is an invitation to costly disputes. Mr. Speaker, if we're going to create a statewide entitlement funded by a payroll tax with sweeping definitions and expansive liability provisions, we must ensure the framework is clear, predictable, and sustainable.

[02:40:32] And in its current form, this bill is not. For those reasons, I respectfully ask that we vote no. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Delegate from Prince William, Delegate Sewell. Mr. Speaker, thank you.

[02:40:49] Speaking to the bill. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise in response to misinformation on the House floor yesterday and an off-color joke made earlier today on the House floor about paid family and medical leave, and it's important to Virginia families.

[02:41:06] I'm grateful for colleagues who recognize that family is not defined by politics, but by love, responsibility, and sacrifice. And the only tax that Virginia families are being hit with right now, as noted in a February 2026 report from the Nonpartisan Tax Foundation, is from the Trump administration, which notes that tariffs are expected to cost the average American household $1,300. Today, we have the chance to honor families. We have the chance to honor spouses,

[02:41:39] parents, guardians, those in local parentis, and the next of kin who step forward in life's moments that matter most. And as the daughter of two Air Force veterans, I know firsthand that family, both blood and by choice, is a foundation of service, resilience, and community.

[02:42:02] So today's yes vote on House Bill 1207 demonstrates that not only that we are, that no family should have to choose between their livelihood and their loved ones. Shall the bill pass?

[02:42:26] Clerk will close the row. Ayes 62, noes 34. Ayes 62, noes 34. The bill passes. House Bill 1220 relates to photo speed monitoring devices, placement and operation.

[02:42:56] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 67, noes 29.

[02:43:11] Ayes 67, noes 29, the bill passes. House Bill 1238 relates to local ordinances, regulations of pet shops. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[02:43:32] Ayes 58, noes 36. Ayes 58, noes 36, the bill passes. House Bill 1263 relates to collective bargaining by public employees, individual home care providers, Virginia Home Care Authority established, public employee relations board established, exclusive bargaining representatives.

[02:43:50] Delegate from Warren County, Delegate Oaks. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speaking to the bill. Delegate has the floor. The one request that my local community made when they sent me here was no unfunded mandates from Richmond. Sometimes the clearest warnings don't come from politicians in this chamber.

[02:44:07] They come from the people actually responsible for making budgets work back home. Leaders on the ground are begging us to slow down. Even the Democratic chairman of the Prince William County

School Board is warning us that this is a mistake.

[02:44:23] As reported by WJLA-TV, Babur LaTeve said, and I'm paraphrasing his quote, this new bill wants to mandate collective bargaining and mandate what's called binding arbitration, which forces districts to pay a salary based on some unelected person who tells us what we have to do.

[02:44:42] The current bill as it stands doesn't fund the mandate. If this bill passes, it will be the single largest tax increase in Virginia history, and it will bankrupt local governments and bankrupt school divisions.

[02:44:58] This is a Democrat, a school board chairman, a local leader who supports collective bargaining, and even he says this bill is an unfunded mandate from Richmond that will crush local budgets and drive up property taxes on our working families.

[02:45:15] This is how services get cut. This is how class sizes grow. This is how we put fewer deputies on our street. And so I would ask that we should be making life more affordable for Virginians, not locking local governments into mandates they can't pay for.

[02:45:33] For our schools, for our taxpayers, and for our local communities, I respectfully request my colleagues in the House vote no on this bill. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Tran. Thank you so much, Mr. Speaker. I rise to speak to this bill.

[02:45:51] Y'all can ask the floor. Thank you. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 1263 provides our public sector employees with the right to collectively bargain. These are our teachers. These are our firefighters. These are our home care workers. These are people who make sure that the most vulnerable amongst us get the supports and services they need to thrive.

[02:46:12] Collective bargaining is an opportunity for workers to come together and to have a seat at the table, to have a voice in the workplace. And our roots in banning collective bargaining was part of Jim Crow. Back during a time when nurses at UVA wanted to collectively bargain, the state responded by banning it entirely.

[02:46:35] And we made strides in the last couple of years under the leadership of Delegate Elizabeth Guzman, also from Prince William, when we gave localities the option to allow for collective bargaining. And now we have a moment not only to turn back on Jim Crow, but to take a positive step forward for over 300,000 public sector employees across Virginia and to give them a seat at the table.

[02:47:00] And at a time, Mr. Speaker, when President Trump is denigrating and disrespecting our Our public sector workers, we have an opportunity to stand with them right now, right here in Virginia. And I urge all my colleagues to support our public sector collective bargaining bill.

[02:47:15] Thank you. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[02:47:39] Ayes, 61. Noes, 35. Ayes, 61. Noes, 35. The bill passes. House Bill 1266 would direct the Department of Environmental Quality to publish an updated version of the environmental justice in the permitting process guideline memo to consider how to assess cumulative impacts of certain permits. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 63, noes 34. Ayes 63,

[02:48:14] noes 34. The bill passes. House Bill 1272, now before you, relates to regulation of electronic gaming devices. Penalties. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 59, noes 36, abstentions 1. Ayes 59, noes 36, abstentions 1. The bill passes. House Bill 1318 relates to

[02:48:51] hospitals, emergency department, physicians. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 90, noes 7. Ayes 90, noes 7. The bill passes. Ayes bill 1330 relates to speed safety cameras, pedestrian crossing violation monitoring systems, and stop sign violation monitoring systems,

[02:49:20] placement and operation, violation enforcement, civil penalties. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 66, noes 30. Ayes 66, noes 30. The bill passes. Ayes bill 1344, It relates to Special License Plates, Sons of Confederate Veterans, and Robert E. Lee.

[02:49:48] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 62, noes 34.

[02:50:03] Ayes 62, noes 34. The bill passes. House Bill 1366 relates to the Department of Social Services, Corrective Action Plans, and Assumption of Temporary Control of Local Boards and Local Departments. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[02:50:32] Ayes 91, noes 6. Ayes 91, noes 6. The bill passes. House Bill 1373 would require the Department of Education to assess potential enhancements and strategies to maximize utilization of funds designated for regional and special education students in order to decrease the number of referrals of students with disabilities into private day school placements report.

[02:50:54] Shall the bill pass? Interesting. Clerk will close the row. Ayes 65, noes 31.

[02:51:11] Ayes 65, noes 31. The bill passes. House Bill 1393, now before he relates to electric utilities, pilot program for energy assistance and weatherization for certain individuals, cost recovery for certain electrical facilities. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 66, no's 31. Ayes 66, no's 31. The bill passes. House bill 1400 relates to health insurance coverage for maternal mental

[02:51:48] health screenings. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 66, no's 30. Ayes 66, no's 30.

[02:52:10] the bill passes. House bill 1411 relates to evidence of defendant's mental condition admissible. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 62, noes 35. Ayes 62, noes 35. The bill passes. House bill 1413 relates to limitation on sentence upon revocation of suspension of

[02:52:37] sentence technical violations. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 62, noes 35. Ayes 62, No. 35. The bill passes. House Bill 1414 relates to requirement that certain injuries to children be reported by physicians, nurses, teachers, etc. Penalties for failure to report. Shall the bill

[02:53:09] pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 91. No. 5. Ayes 91. No. 5. The bill passes. House Bill 1415 relates to the public funding for multifamily residential housing, common household pets, the Virginia Residential Landlord and Tenant Act. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[02:53:48] Ayes, 60, noes, 34. Ayes, 60, noes, 34. The bill passes. House Bill 1421 would direct the Office of Secretary of Public Safety and Homeland Security to convene a work group to evaluate the feasibility of transferring administrative and supervisory authority of the State Board of Local and Regional Jails to another state agency or an independent oversight body.

[02:54:10] Delegate from Campbell. Delegate Zare. Oh, sorry. I apologize. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[02:54:29] Ayes 65, noes 31. Ayes 65, noes 31. The bill passes. House Bill 1465, now before he relates to powers and duties of the Marine Products Board, full-time equivalent position established, marketing and production of blue catfish. Shall the bill pass?

[02:54:50] Clerk will close the row. Ayes 94, noes 2. Ayes 94, noes 2. The bill passes. House Bill 1475, relates to Virginia Fungi Task Force established.

[02:55:11] report shall the bill pass have one of them close the book eyes 65 knows 31 65 knows 31 the bill passes hospital 1483 relates to election of certain governing bodies single-member districts

[02:55:40] required shall the bill pass circle close the row eyes 65 knows 32 65 knows 32 the bill passes house bill 1490 relates to the former service of services centralized hotline for reports or complaints of child abuse or neglect response to complaints within 24 hours for children under

[02:56:12] three years of age. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 89, noes 7. Ayes 89, noes 7. The bill passes. House Bill 1524 relates to carrying assault firearms in public areas

[02:56:36] prohibited. Penalty. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 54, noes 41. Ayes 54, no's 41 the bill passes house bill uh 145 relates uh to fantasy contest act regulation and taxation

[02:57:07] shall the bill pass clerk will close the row ayes 89 no's eight ayes 89 no's eight the bill passes house bill uh 271 relates to the virginia gaming commission established penalties shall the bill

[02:57:34] pass clerk will close the row ayes 90 no seven ayes 90 no seven the bill passes House Bill 308 relates to the Virginia Alcoholic Beverage Control Authority permitting of retail tobacco product retailers purchase, possession, and sale of retail tobacco products penalties.

[02:58:05] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 95, no zero.

[02:58:20] Ayes 95, no zero. The bill passes. House Bill 564 relates to parking, stopping, and standing enforcement, plus obstruction monitoring system civil penalties. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[02:58:42] Ayes, 80. Noes, 14. Ayes, 80. Noes, 14. The bill passes. House Bill 790 relates to hotel policies, denial of guests residing within certain distance prohibited in certain instances. Shall the bill pass?

[02:59:02] Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 95. Noes, 1. Ayes, 95. Noes, 1. The bill passes. House Bill 973 relates to health records, disclosure of laboratory test results, waiting period.

[02:59:22] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 94, noes, 2.

[02:59:39] Ayes, 94, noes, 2. The bill passes. House Bill 1075, now before he would direct the State Corporation Commission to consider certain requirements in the biennial rate review for a Phase 1 utility report. Shall the bill pass?

[02:59:58] Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 85, noes, 12. Ayes, 85, noes, 12. The bill passes. House Bill 1224 relates to driver's licenses requirements for initial licensure.

[03:00:16] persons age 18 to 21. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 88, noes 9. Ayes 88, noes 9. The bill passes. That's bill 1273, relates to transportation network companies,

[03:00:40] requirements, civil penalties. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 91, noes 6.

[03:00:59] Ayes 91, noes 6. The bill passes. That's bill 1339, relates to special license plates, Virginia Realtors. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 96, noes 0. Ayes 96, noes 0.

[03:01:22] The bill passes. And then going back, if you're following along on the printed calendar, go back and pick up three of the bills that were removed from the uncontested to the contested. House Bill 845, now before you, relates to unlawful detainer, bifurcation, contested rent, and damages.

[03:01:38] Shall the bill pass? Yes, sir. It's there. Clerk will close the roll.

[03:01:59] Ms. Speaker, ayes 74, noes 23. Ayes 74, noes 23, the bill passes. On page 15, we pick up next House Bill 1361, which relates to the Virginia Residential Landlord and Tenant Act, Civil Action for Unlawful Detainer, Termination Notice, Energy Submetering Equipment.

[03:02:23] Shall the bill pass? Okay. Clerk, we'll close the roll. Ayes 79, noes 18.

[03:02:39] Ayes 79, noes 18, the bill passes. Same page, new bill, House Bill 1363, now before you, relates to family abuse of protective orders, conditions imposed upon issuance. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[03:03:09] Ayes 87, noes 10. Ayes 87, noes 10, the bill passes. And Mr. Speaker, members of the House, we go back to the bill that was taken by temporarily earlier, House Bill 161, relates to the Virginia Lottery, casinos, internet gaming, authorized penalties.

[03:03:27] bill is before you. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 67, nos 30. Ayes 67, nos 30. The bill passes. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, having voted on the prevailing side by which we passed House Bill 1272 on page 126, I move that we now

[03:04:02] reconsider that vote. Delegate from Fairfax, having voted on the prevailing side by which we passed HB 1272 found on page 126, we'd like to reconsider that vote. All those in favor say aye all those opposed no hb 1272 found on page 126 madam clerk shall the bill pass well

[03:04:24] clerk will close the roll ayes 52 nose 41 abstentions 2. ayes 52 nose 41 abstentions 2

[03:04:56] the bill passes continuing with today's calendar uh we come to a final category if you recall earlier in the day uh on page 74 we took house bill uh 786 um it was moved uh motion we considered and taken back to second reading so house bill 786 um which seeks to amend and reenact section of the code of virginia relating to school boards authority to prohibit sale of energy drinks to students in public high schools legislation report committee on education the only from

[03:05:32] Thank you Mr. Speaker and Mr. Speaker I rise for a motion and I'd like to speak to that motion. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker I'm going to move to adopt the floor substitute. What the floor substitute does is take us back to the version as a left committee.

[03:05:52] So there was an introduced version and then there were a couple of words that were inserted all or any variety of, which gave them an opportunity to the school boards to permissively prohibit some of these caffeinated beverages.

[03:06:09] So I would move the floor substitute. Mr. Speaker, I apologize. Clerk will report the floor substitute. Yes, sir. House Bill 786 floor amendment, nature of the substitute by Delegate Austin. It is available to the members here of IHOD and to the public online through the legislative information system.

[03:06:25] I apologize for not reporting it earlier. All those in favor of adopting the floor substitute shall say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The floor substitute is adopted. The delegate from Roanoke, Delegate

Rasul. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Now I would move that we engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading?

[03:06:41] All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Roanoke, Delegate Rasul. Further motion, Mr. Speaker. I would move that the House dispense with the third constitutional reading of the bill, Mr. Speaker, and I believe that's a recorded vote.

[03:06:57] Madam Clerk, are you ready? Shall the constitutional reading be dispensed with? Clerk will close the row.

[03:07:18] Ayes, 94, noes, 0. Ayes, 94, noes, 0. Constitutional reading is dispensed. The delegate for the row, no. Delegate Rasul. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill pass. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[03:07:43] Ayes, 83, noes, 13, abstentions, 1. Ayes, 83, noes, 13, abstentions, 1. The bill passes. Mr. Speaker, on this crossover, a little after 1 o'clock, that completes today's calendar. Per House Rule 51, the House has returned to the morning hour.

[03:07:58] Does the clerk have any additional announcements or communications? No communications, just several announcements. There are no legislative meetings going on this afternoon. Looking ahead to tomorrow, February 18th, Speaker's Interfaith Devotional will be at 7 a.m. in the Speaker's 14th floor conference room.

[03:08:18] Conservative Energy Caucus is meeting at 7.30 a.m. tomorrow. They will be in the 7th floor of House North Subcommittee Room, so Conservative Energy Caucus will be there at 730, the Historically Backed College University Caucus. HBCU will be meeting at 730 tomorrow.

[03:08:36] They'll be in the House Subcommittee Room 10 on the 10th floor. Military and Veterans Caucus will be meeting at 8. They will be on the Senate Subcommittee Room on the 3rd floor, Room 300, for the Military and Veterans Caucus. And then legislatively, the Committee on Education will be meeting at 9:30 AM, and they'll be in the House Committee Room A on the lower level.

[03:09:00] The Democratic caucus will be meeting tomorrow at 11.15, and Republicans at 11.30. And this just in, there's going to be a new category, a new meeting of the Elocution Caucus that I'm going to be holding upstairs in my conference room for how to pronounce per flora.

[03:09:21] Al-Khal, Fungi, Freytum, and Delegate Weber might join me. So anyone's invited to come join with that. That completes all the announcements I have. The Delegate from Loudoun County, Delegate Reed.

[03:09:38] Yes, Mr. Speaker, just one correction to the announcements. The Delegate has the floor. The Military and Veterans Caucus will be in Senate Room 3 in the Anax, so not up in Room 300. So Senate Room 3 in the Anax, tomorrow at 8 o'clock. Delegate from Fauquier, Delegate Weber.

[03:09:55] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for an announcement. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, tomorrow is one of my favorite days. Well, I aim to get my belt back from Shell E. Simons. The oyster eating contest will commence tomorrow.

[03:10:14] The Chesapeake Bay Foundation is providing us with raw oysters. Contestants this year, unfortunately, Betsy's going to be unable to join us this year. But taking her place, Delegate Hernandez is going to see if he can take on Shelley as well.

[03:10:32] And he doesn't know it yet, but we are recruiting Delegate Pence to come join us as well. And the rules are that you have to show up. You have to be on time. Hernandez was disqualified last year because he was late. You have to commence to eat a boat ton of oysters.

[03:10:51] And those with the greatest spirit tends to win, which is why Shelly, with her swag that she had last year, beat the two-time champion who was me. So tomorrow, don't eat breakfast because oysters will be served. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[03:11:08] Mr. Clark. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, just out of abundance of consideration for your colleagues, not everyone gets to enjoy bivalves. So if you partake of the shellfish, please do not bring it into the chamber.

[03:11:23] I just would appreciate that. It will help a couple of folks here. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that when the House adjourned today, adjourn to reconvene tomorrow at 12 noon. The Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring, moves that the House adjourn today to reconvene tomorrow at 12 noon.

[03:11:41] Does men in favor of the motion? We'll say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House do now adjourn. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring moves that the House do now adjourn. Does men in favor of the motion? We'll say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. The House stands adjourned until tomorrow at 12 noon.

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